

Fine for Google's street view

France has imposed a fine on Google accusing it of gathering unwarranted data

Carriers dread 4G

Service providers are dreading the fact that the faster LTE technology would not suffice the ever increasing bandwidth demands

The Galaxy Fit and the Xperia X10 Mini also had the best cameras of the lot. If anything, Sony Ericsson loses out with a mediocre 950 mAh battery.

And the winner is

Its poor performance in zone three notwithstanding, the Galaxy Fit did well in most of the other tests. Its combination of price (₹10,350) and a very nice feature list put it at the top of our value charts. It wins our Digit Best Buy award and is the best multi-purpose Android phone at just over the ₹10,000 mark.



Samsung Galaxy fit

test of price drops, to make way for newer handsets. The HTC Desire and Motorola Milestone are two such phones. In fact the Desire is now a cool ₹5,000 cheaper, and this doesn't make it any less capable. However, newer phones generally hog the limelight.

Features, build and usability

The Motorola Defy has to be the most unique Android phone in this comparison, and we're not talking about gimmicky form factors. It is actu-

ally advertised as being water resistant up to 1 meter, which basically means you can submerge it in up to a meter of water with no bad effects. While we couldn't test the validity of this statement, for lack of a deep enough water body near office, we did pour water on it while playing a YouTube – as far as we know, the Defy is still working. The rubberised body and flaps for ports is what makes the innards of this device water resistant. Although the Defy has a 3.7-inch display, it feels quite compact, and despite the

selling point being its water resistance, it has a pretty crisp display, and nice clean lines. The Acer Liquid Metal is heavy on account of its steel construction. The entire phone has a curved design, and this makes the device look thicker than it is.

The HTC Legend is an ageing device that is reasonably compact and feels solid on account of the single piece metal body. The Milestone is a pretty solid device, with a QWERTY keypad that we still feel is a little too flat to be termed as intuitive – key feedback is strictly decent, but the flat keys aren't as usable as Motorola would have you believe. Unlike the Milestone that has dated hardware and

interface has become better over the past few years.

Performance

The Desire would be our pick of the bunch in the signal reception test. Unfortunate then, that the loudspeaker and earpiece have strictly decent clarity. In fact the loudspeaker in particular sounds tinny, and distorts at maximum volume. None of these phones are really suitable for music and neither are any of the phones very good camera phones. If you're looking for an Android device with an excellent camera, you'll have to look elsewhere.

If you are looking for an excellent display, the HTC Desire with the S-LCD screen is easily the pick of the bunch. The Motorola Defy also has a very crisp display, although it isn't as vivid as the HTC Desire's display.

As we've seen in earlier categories, picking an out and out winner from amongst this group isn't easy, simply because none of them really stands out over the others in any one test.

And the winner is

When features and performance are close price plays a big role in determining our Best Buy. This is because we compute winners on the basis of the overall score of the device versus its price. After grading these phones, we found there were only minor differences in overall scores, although different phones performed differently in individual tests. This

Phones between ₹17,501 and ₹23,000 The true middlemen

Phones in this price category have, perhaps the toughest task of all. They have, on one hand, cheaper phones beneath them that compete tooth and nail for features. On the other hand, if one were to look at spending ₹20,000 or so on a phone, why not spend 5000 bucks more and get a truly high-end device with better hardware and bragging rights? This is a route many users take, while many more go the opposite one – buy a cheaper phone with a smaller display and do without a few extra features and frills, but save a bunch of dough. Yet if you've been looking for a really feature-rich Android phone, and haven't found it thus far, there is a good chance you will find it here. There is a lot of variety in this category, partly due to flagship devices of yesteryear that find themselves in this category – cour-



A NEW PHONE EVERY DAY?

As a Digit Test Centre Reviewer you actually get paid to use and write about phones like these.

Send your CVs to
editor@thinkdigit.com
to apply.

HURRY
LIMITED
VACANCIES

ally advertised as being water resistant up to 1 meter, which basically means you can submerge it in up to a meter of water with no bad effects. While we couldn't test the validity of this statement, for lack of a deep enough water body near office, we did pour water on it while playing a YouTube – as far as we know, the Defy is still working. The rubberised body and flaps for ports is what makes the innards of this device water resistant. Although the Defy has a 3.7-inch display, it feels quite compact, and despite the

feels a bit sluggish, the HTC Desire has a 1 GHz processor, and while it is based on an older SoC, (the QSD8250), it can still run with some of the newer devices around, and with Android 2.2, the Desire doesn't feel sluggish at all.

In terms of interface, we'd say the HTC Desire feels really polished, and HTC's Sense user



Motorola defy